

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Official Language - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / WORKBOOK INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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Official Language - Solved Practice Workbook

Subject: Polity | **GS Paper:** GS-II | **Control date:** 8 September 2026

Practice discipline: exactly 32 original MCQs before PYQs; answer order ABCD repeated eight times; 128 unique option-specific explanations; 32 question-specific traps; one verified direct Prelims PYQ; exactly six original Mains models.

Exactly **32 original MCQs** appear below before the PYQ section. Questions 25-32 are targeted remediation. Correct-option sequence: ABCDABCDABCDABCDABCDABCDABCDABCD.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

MCQ 1. Constitutional status

Which statement is constitutionally correct?

A. Hindi in Devanagari script is the official language of the Union, but the Constitution declares no national language. B. Hindi is the national language and English is its subordinate associate language. C. All Eighth-Schedule languages are official languages of the Union. D. English is the sole official language named in Article 343.

Answer: A. Hindi in Devanagari script is the official language of the Union, but the Constitution declares no national language.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Correct. Article 343(1) uses the functional expression official language of the Union; no constitutional provision declares a national language.
- **B:** Incorrect. The Constitution does not use a Hindi-national/English-associate hierarchy. The controlling rule is: Article 343(1) uses the functional expression official language of the Union; no constitutional provision declares a national language.
- **C:** Incorrect. Scheduled recognition does not confer Union-official status on all 22 languages. The controlling rule is: Article 343(1) uses the functional expression official language of the Union; no constitutional provision declares a national language.
- **D:** Incorrect. Article 343 names Hindi, not English, as the Union's official language. The controlling rule is: Article 343(1) uses the functional expression official language of the Union; no constitutional provision declares a national language.

Examiner trap 1: Do not convert official-language status into national-language status.

MCQ 2. Numerals under Article 343

Article 343(1) specifies which numeral form for Union official purposes?

A. Devanagari numerals only. B. The international form of Indian numerals. C. Roman numerals as defined by Parliament. D. Any numeral form selected by each Ministry.

Answer: B. The international form of Indian numerals.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect. Devanagari is the script specified for Hindi, not the default numeral form. The controlling rule is: Article 343(1) separates Hindi's Devanagari script from the international form of Indian numerals.
- **B:** Correct. Article 343(1) separates Hindi's Devanagari script from the international form of Indian numerals.
- **C:** Incorrect. The Constitution itself supplies the form; no annual parliamentary definition is needed. The controlling rule is: Article 343(1) separates Hindi's Devanagari script from the international form of Indian numerals.
- **D:** Incorrect. Individual Ministries cannot replace the constitutional numeral rule by preference. The controlling rule is: Article 343(1) separates Hindi's Devanagari script from the international form of Indian numerals.

Examiner trap 2: Script and numeral form are separate constitutional choices.

MCQ 3. Transition and continuation

Which proposition correctly connects Article 343(2) and Article 343(3)?

A. Clause (2) permanently guarantees English and clause (3) repeals Hindi. B. Clause (2) authorised only Hindi during 1950-1965. C. Clause (2) continued English for fifteen years, while clause (3) authorised Parliament to provide for later English use. D. Clause (3) lets the President continue English without legislation.

Answer: C. Clause (2) continued English for fifteen years, while clause (3) authorised Parliament to provide for later English use.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect. Clause (2) was time-limited and did not repeal Hindi's clause (1) status. The controlling rule is: Clause (2) supplied the transitional period and clause (3) supplied parliamentary legislative power for the post-transition period.
- **B:** Incorrect. Clause (2) continued English rather than excluding it. The controlling rule is: Clause (2) supplied the transitional period and clause (3) supplied parliamentary legislative power for the post-transition period.
- **C:** Correct. Clause (2) supplied the transitional period and clause (3) supplied parliamentary legislative power for the post-transition period.
- **D:** Incorrect. Clause (3) assigns the decision to Parliament by law, not unilateral presidential order. The controlling rule is: Clause (2) supplied the transitional period and clause (3) supplied parliamentary legislative power for the post-transition period.

Examiner trap 3: Do not say English automatically ended in 1965.

MCQ 4. Article 344 timing

When did Article 344(1) require the President to constitute the Official Language Commission?

A. Every five years indefinitely. B. Whenever the statutory committee requests it. C. Only once, in 1976. D. At the expiration of five years and then ten years from constitutional commencement.

Answer: D. At the expiration of five years and then ten years from constitutional commencement.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect. Article 344 does not prescribe indefinite five-year recurrence. The controlling rule is: The constitutional text identifies two time points measured from commencement, not a recurring decennial cycle.
- **B:** Incorrect. A statutory committee request is not the constitutional trigger. The controlling rule is: The constitutional text identifies two time points measured from commencement, not a recurring decennial cycle.
- **C:** Incorrect. 1976 relates to later statutory/rule implementation, not the first Commission requirement. The controlling rule is: The constitutional text identifies two time points measured from commencement, not a recurring decennial cycle.
- **D:** Correct. The constitutional text identifies two time points measured from commencement, not a recurring decennial cycle.

Examiner trap 4: The Article 344 Commission was time-linked, not permanently periodic.

MCQ 5. Commission membership

Who may be represented among members of the Article 344 Commission?

A. The different languages specified in the Eighth Schedule. B. Only States that have adopted Hindi. C. Only members of Parliament. D. Every language claimed in a pending inclusion demand.

Answer: A. The different languages specified in the Eighth Schedule.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Correct. Article 344(1) directs representation of the different languages specified in the Eighth Schedule.
- **B:** Incorrect. Hindi-official-language status is not the membership criterion. The controlling rule is: Article 344(1) directs representation of the different languages specified in the Eighth Schedule.

- **C:** Incorrect. The Commission is not constitutionally limited to parliamentarians. The controlling rule is: Article 344(1) directs representation of the different languages specified in the Eighth Schedule.
- **D:** Incorrect. A pending demand does not equal Eighth-Schedule inclusion. The controlling rule is: Article 344(1) directs representation of the different languages specified in the Eighth Schedule.

Examiner trap 5: Scheduled-language representation is a Commission function, not Union-official status.

MCQ 6. Constitutional committee

Which composition and election method belong to the committee under Article 344(4)?

A. Fifteen members from each House, nominated by the President. B. Twenty Lok Sabha and ten Rajya Sabha members, elected by PR-STV in their Houses. C. Twenty Chief Ministers and ten Governors. D. Thirty members selected by the Union Home Minister.

Answer: B. Twenty Lok Sabha and ten Rajya Sabha members, elected by PR-STV in their Houses.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect. The Houses are not equally represented and presidential nomination is not the method. The controlling rule is: Article 344(4) fixes a 20:10 House composition and election by proportional representation through the single transferable vote.
- **B:** Correct. Article 344(4) fixes a 20:10 House composition and election by proportional representation through the single transferable vote.
- **C:** Incorrect. State executives do not constitute this parliamentary committee. The controlling rule is: Article 344(4) fixes a 20:10 House composition and election by proportional representation through the single transferable vote.
- **D:** Incorrect. The Union Home Minister does not select the constitutional committee's members. The controlling rule is: Article 344(4) fixes a 20:10 House composition and election by proportional representation through the single transferable vote.

Examiner trap 6: Similar numbers do not make the Article 344 and section 4 committees identical.

MCQ 7. Article 344 balancing factor

Which consideration is expressly required by Article 344(3)?

A. Replacing every State language with Hindi. B. Giving automatic promotion preference to bilingual officials. C. Industrial, cultural and scientific advancement and the just claims of non-Hindi-speaking areas in public services. D. Converting the Eighth Schedule into a list of court languages.

Answer: C. Industrial, cultural and scientific advancement and the just claims of non-Hindi-speaking areas in public services.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect. State-language replacement is absent from clause (3). The controlling rule is: Clause (3) expressly combines national advancement considerations with the claims and interests of non-Hindi-speaking areas in public services.
- **B:** Incorrect. The clause protects interests but creates no automatic promotion preference. The controlling rule is: Clause (3) expressly combines national advancement considerations with the claims and interests of non-Hindi-speaking areas in public services.
- **C:** Correct. Clause (3) expressly combines national advancement considerations with the claims and interests of non-Hindi-speaking areas in public services.
- **D:** Incorrect. It does not alter Article 348 or create scheduled court languages. The controlling rule is: Clause (3) expressly combines national advancement considerations with the claims and interests of non-Hindi-speaking areas in public services.

Examiner trap 7: Article 344 contains an express non-Hindi-interest safeguard.

MCQ 8. Section 3(5) lock

What must occur before the specified section 3 protections for English may be discontinued?

A. A Cabinet resolution alone. B. A recommendation of the statutory committee alone. C. A resolution of any one non-Hindi State and the Lok Sabha. D. Resolutions of all States that have not adopted Hindi as official language, followed by a resolution in each House of Parliament.

Answer: D. Resolutions of all States that have not adopted Hindi as official language, followed by a resolution in each House of Parliament.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect. Executive preference cannot satisfy the statutory legislative lock. The controlling rule is: Section 3(5) requires the complete State set described in the Act and then separate approval by both Houses.
- **B:** Incorrect. The committee recommends; it does not itself discontinue English. The controlling rule is: Section 3(5) requires the complete State set described in the Act and then separate approval by both Houses.
- **C:** Incorrect. One State and one House fall short of both statutory stages. The controlling rule is: Section 3(5) requires the complete State set described in the Act and then separate approval by both Houses.
- **D:** Correct. Section 3(5) requires the complete State set described in the Act and then separate approval by both Houses.

Examiner trap 8: The safeguard is a double legislative lock, not an executive switch.

MCQ 9. Union-State communication

Under section 3(1), communication between the Union and a State that has not adopted Hindi as its official language must use:

A. English. B. Hindi without translation. C. Only the State's regional language. D. Any scheduled language chosen by the Union.

Answer: A. English.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Correct. The first proviso to section 3(1) says English shall be used for this communication.
- **B:** Incorrect. Hindi-only communication contradicts the mandatory proviso. The controlling rule is: The first proviso to section 3(1) says English shall be used for this communication.
- **C:** Incorrect. The Act does not require the Union to use only the State's regional language in this route. The controlling rule is: The first proviso to section 3(1) says English shall be used for this communication.
- **D:** Incorrect. Scheduled status does not create a free Union choice for this communication. The controlling rule is: The first proviso to section 3(1) says English shall be used for this communication.

Examiner trap 9: For this route, the Act says English shall be used.

MCQ 10. Bilingual instruments

Which provision requires both Hindi and English for specified Union resolutions, rules, notifications, reports, contracts and notices?

A. Article 347. B. Section 3(3) of the Official Languages Act. C. Section 6 of the Act. D. Rule 10 alone.

Answer: B. Section 3(3) of the Official Languages Act.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect. Article 347 concerns presidential recognition of a language in a State. The controlling rule is: Section 3(3) directly imposes bilingual use on enumerated high-value official instruments.
- **B:** Correct. Section 3(3) directly imposes bilingual use on enumerated high-value official instruments.
- **C:** Incorrect. Section 6 concerns authorised Hindi translation of specified State laws. The controlling rule is: Section 3(3) directly imposes bilingual use on enumerated high-value official instruments.

- **D:** Incorrect. Rule 10 defines working knowledge and does not create the statutory document list. The controlling rule is: Section 3(3) directly imposes bilingual use on enumerated high-value official instruments.

Examiner trap 10: The bilingual-document duty comes from the Act and is implemented by Rule 6.

MCQ 11. Employee protection

Section 3(4) requires official-language rules to ensure that Union employees proficient in either Hindi or English:

A. must acquire both before performing any work. B. may refuse every translation request. C. can function effectively and are not disadvantaged merely for lacking proficiency in both. D. receive automatic seniority.

Answer: C. can function effectively and are not disadvantaged merely for lacking proficiency in both.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect. The statutory protection exists precisely because universal dual proficiency is not required. The controlling rule is: The subsection combines efficient disposal, public interest and non-disadvantage for employees proficient in either language.
- **B:** Incorrect. Translation duties remain governed by the Act and Rules. The controlling rule is: The subsection combines efficient disposal, public interest and non-disadvantage for employees proficient in either language.
- **C:** Correct. The subsection combines efficient disposal, public interest and non-disadvantage for employees proficient in either language.
- **D:** Incorrect. The provision protects effective functioning, not automatic seniority. The controlling rule is: The subsection combines efficient disposal, public interest and non-disadvantage for employees proficient in either language.

Examiner trap 11: Hindi promotion is statutorily paired with efficiency and employee fairness.

MCQ 12. Section 8

What is the legal function of section 8 of the Official Languages Act?

A. It adds languages to the Eighth Schedule. B. It authorises every State to alter Supreme Court language. C. It declares Hindi the national language. D. It empowers Central rule-making and requires parliamentary laying for a total of thirty days.

Answer: D. It empowers Central rule-making and requires parliamentary laying for a total of thirty days.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect. Scheduled-language addition needs constitutional amendment. The controlling rule is: Section 8 is a delegated-legislation provision with Gazette notification and a parliamentary modification or annulment process.
- **B:** Incorrect. Supreme Court language remains governed by Article 348 and parliamentary law. The controlling rule is: Section 8 is a delegated-legislation provision with Gazette notification and a parliamentary modification or annulment process.
- **C:** Incorrect. The Act contains no national-language declaration. The controlling rule is: Section 8 is a delegated-legislation provision with Gazette notification and a parliamentary modification or annulment process.
- **D:** Correct. Section 8 is a delegated-legislation provision with Gazette notification and a parliamentary modification or annulment process.

Examiner trap 12: Rules under section 8 carry out the Act; they cannot amend the Constitution.

MCQ 13. Section 5

Section 5(1) chiefly provides for:

A. President-authorised Gazette Hindi translations of specified Central laws and instruments to be authoritative in Hindi. B. automatic authoritative status for every private Hindi translation. C. State selection of official languages. D. mother-tongue primary education.

Answer: A. President-authorised Gazette Hindi translations of specified Central laws and instruments to be authoritative in Hindi.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Correct. The provision covers specified Central Acts, Presidential Ordinances and delegated instruments published under presidential authority in the Official Gazette.
- **B:** Incorrect. Private accuracy is not the statutory authorisation required by section 5. The controlling rule is: The provision covers specified Central Acts, Presidential Ordinances and delegated instruments published under presidential authority in the Official Gazette.
- **C:** Incorrect. State official-language choice belongs to Article 345 and State law. The controlling rule is: The provision covers specified Central Acts, Presidential Ordinances and delegated instruments published under presidential authority in the Official Gazette.
- **D:** Incorrect. Mother-tongue instruction is addressed by Article 350A. The controlling rule is: The provision covers specified Central Acts, Presidential Ordinances and delegated instruments published under presidential authority in the Official Gazette.

Examiner trap 13: Authority depends on presidential authority and Gazette publication.

MCQ 14. Section 6

When a State has prescribed a non-Hindi language for its Acts or Governor's Ordinances, section 6 permits:

A. replacement of the Article 348(3) English translation by Hindi. B. a Governor-authorised Gazette Hindi translation in addition to the required English translation. C. the High Court to choose any language without consent. D. Parliament to add the State language to the Eighth Schedule by rule.

Answer: B. a Governor-authorised Gazette Hindi translation in addition to the required English translation.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect. The statutory text says in addition to, not instead of, the English translation. The controlling rule is: Section 6 adds an authoritative Hindi text while expressly preserving the Article 348(3) English translation.
- **B:** Correct. Section 6 adds an authoritative Hindi text while expressly preserving the Article 348(3) English translation.
- **C:** Incorrect. High Court language is governed by Article 348(2) and section 7. The controlling rule is: Section 6 adds an authoritative Hindi text while expressly preserving the Article 348(3) English translation.
- **D:** Incorrect. Eighth-Schedule amendment cannot be accomplished by an ordinary rule. The controlling rule is: Section 6 adds an authoritative Hindi text while expressly preserving the Article 348(3) English translation.

Examiner trap 14: Section 6 supplements Article 348(3); it does not displace it.

MCQ 15. Section 7

Which condition accurately describes section 7 use of Hindi or a State official language for a High Court judgment?

A. The Chief Justice may authorise it without any executive consent. B. It automatically becomes the sole all-India authoritative version. C. The Governor acts with previous presidential consent, and a High Court-authorised English translation must accompany the non-English judgment. D. It applies equally to Supreme Court judgments.

Answer: C. The Governor acts with previous presidential consent, and a High Court-authorised English translation must accompany the non-English judgment.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect. The statutory actor and prior-consent requirement cannot be omitted. The controlling rule is: Section 7 uses the Governor-President consent route and preserves an accompanying English translation under High Court authority.
- **B:** Incorrect. The non-English version does not eliminate the accompanying English text. The controlling rule is: Section 7 uses the Governor-President consent route and preserves an accompanying English translation under High Court authority.
- **C:** Correct. Section 7 uses the Governor-President consent route and preserves an accompanying English translation under High Court authority.
- **D:** Incorrect. Section 7 is confined to the High Court for the State. The controlling rule is: Section 7 uses the Governor-President consent route and preserves an accompanying English translation under High Court authority.

Examiner trap 15: Proceedings under Article 348(2) and judgments under section 7 are separate routes.

MCQ 16. Rules and Region C

For communication from a Central Government office to a non-Central recipient in Region C, Rule 3 ordinarily requires:

A. Hindi only. B. the recipient's mother tongue only. C. any language in the Eighth Schedule. D. English.

Answer: D. English.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect. Hindi-only treatment belongs to neither the general Region C rule nor constitutional status. The controlling rule is: Rule 3 uses English for the Region C route described, subject to the exact sender-recipient classification.
- **B:** Incorrect. The Rules do not impose a mother-tongue-only requirement. The controlling rule is: Rule 3 uses English for the Region C route described, subject to the exact sender-recipient classification.
- **C:** Incorrect. Scheduled status is not the communication rule. The controlling rule is: Rule 3 uses English for the Region C route described, subject to the exact sender-recipient classification.
- **D:** Correct. Rule 3 uses English for the Region C route described, subject to the exact sender-recipient classification.

Examiner trap 16: Identify both sender and recipient before applying a regional rule.

MCQ 17. Article 345 choice

A State legislature acting under Article 345 may adopt:

A. one or more languages in use in the State or Hindi for all or specified official purposes. B. only languages listed in the Eighth Schedule. C. only one language and only once. D. a new Supreme Court language.

Answer: A. one or more languages in use in the State or Hindi for all or specified official purposes.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Correct. Article 345 expressly permits one or more languages in use in the State or Hindi.
- **B:** Incorrect. The text contains no Eighth-Schedule gate. The controlling rule is: Article 345 expressly permits one or more languages in use in the State or Hindi.
- **C:** Incorrect. U.P. Hindi Sahitya Sammelan confirms the power can be exercised again for an additional language. The controlling rule is: Article 345 expressly permits one or more languages in use in the State or Hindi.
- **D:** Incorrect. Supreme Court language is outside Article 345. The controlling rule is: Article 345 expressly permits one or more languages in use in the State or Hindi.

Examiner trap 17: State official-language status is not limited to scheduled languages.

MCQ 18. Article 346

The main subject of Article 346 is:

A. mother-tongue instruction. B. official communication between States and between a State and the Union. C. authoritative Hindi translations of Central Acts. D. classification of classical languages.

Answer: B. official communication between States and between a State and the Union.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect. Primary mother-tongue facilities belong to Article 350A. The controlling rule is: Article 346 supplies the constitutional communication channel and permits States to agree on Hindi between themselves.
- **B:** Correct. Article 346 supplies the constitutional communication channel and permits States to agree on Hindi between themselves.
- **C:** Incorrect. Authoritative Hindi translations are statutory matters under section 5. The controlling rule is: Article 346 supplies the constitutional communication channel and permits States to agree on Hindi between themselves.
- **D:** Incorrect. Classical recognition is a separate executive scheme. The controlling rule is: Article 346 supplies the constitutional communication channel and permits States to agree on Hindi between themselves.

Examiner trap 18: Article 346 is about governments communicating, not individual language status.

MCQ 19. Article 347

Article 347 permits which response to a linguistic demand?

A. Automatic Eighth-Schedule inclusion after a petition. B. A State Governor may declare a national language. C. The President may direct recognition for all or part of a State and a specified purpose after being satisfied about a substantial proportion. D. The Supreme Court must conduct a referendum.

Answer: C. The President may direct recognition for all or part of a State and a specified purpose after being satisfied about a substantial proportion.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect. Schedule inclusion requires constitutional amendment. The controlling rule is: The provision uses demand, presidential satisfaction, substantial proportion, area and purpose as controlling elements.
- **B:** Incorrect. Neither Governors nor Article 347 create a national language. The controlling rule is: The provision uses demand, presidential satisfaction, substantial proportion, area and purpose as controlling elements.
- **C:** Correct. The provision uses demand, presidential satisfaction, substantial proportion, area and purpose as controlling elements.
- **D:** Incorrect. No referendum mechanism appears in the text. The controlling rule is: The provision uses demand, presidential satisfaction, substantial proportion, area and purpose as controlling elements.

Examiner trap 19: "Substantial proportion" has no fixed percentage in the Article.

MCQ 20. U.P. Hindi Sahitya Sammelan

What did the Supreme Court uphold in U.P. Hindi Sahitya Sammelan v. State of U.P. (2014)?

A. Hindi must be the only State official language after first adoption. B. Article 347 is the exclusive route for every additional language. C. Only Parliament may recognise Urdu for State purposes. D. A State legislature may use Article 345 from time to time to adopt an additional language in use, including Urdu for specified purposes.

Answer: D. A State legislature may use Article 345 from time to time to adopt an additional language in use, including Urdu for specified purposes.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect. The judgment rejected exhaustion of the Article 345 power after adopting Hindi. The controlling rule is: The Court upheld the Uttar Pradesh law and notification recognising Urdu as a second official language for specified purposes.
- **B:** Incorrect. The Court distinguished rather than collapsed Articles 345 and 347. The controlling rule is: The Court upheld the Uttar Pradesh law and notification recognising Urdu as a second official language for specified

purposes.

- **C:** Incorrect. Article 345 places the legislative power in the State legislature. The controlling rule is: The Court upheld the Uttar Pradesh law and notification recognising Urdu as a second official language for specified purposes.
- **D:** Correct. The Court upheld the Uttar Pradesh law and notification recognising Urdu as a second official language for specified purposes.

Examiner trap 20: Article 345 power is continuing and plural, not exhausted by the first choice.

MCQ 21. Article 348 baseline

Until Parliament otherwise provides, Article 348(1) requires English for:

A. Supreme Court and High Court proceedings and authoritative texts of specified legislative instruments. B. all private contracts and conversations. C. every subordinate court without exception. D. all primary education.

Answer: A. Supreme Court and High Court proceedings and authoritative texts of specified legislative instruments.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Correct. Article 348(1) covers superior-court proceedings and listed authoritative legal texts.
- **B:** Incorrect. Private communication is outside Article 348. The controlling rule is: Article 348(1) covers superior-court proceedings and listed authoritative legal texts.
- **C:** Incorrect. The clause names the Supreme Court and every High Court, not every subordinate court. The controlling rule is: Article 348(1) covers superior-court proceedings and listed authoritative legal texts.
- **D:** Incorrect. Education medium is governed by other constitutional and statutory rules. The controlling rule is: Article 348(1) covers superior-court proceedings and listed authoritative legal texts.

Examiner trap 21: Article 348 is wider than courtroom speech because it also governs authoritative texts.

MCQ 22. Article 348(2)

A valid Article 348(2) authorisation requires:

A. a State Cabinet resolution for all courts. B. the Governor, previous presidential consent, and a language used for State official purposes, limited to High Court proceedings. C. a High Court full-court resolution for Supreme Court proceedings. D. an Eighth-Schedule amendment.

Answer: B. the Governor, previous presidential consent, and a language used for State official purposes, limited to High Court proceedings.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect. Cabinet preference cannot replace the constitutional actors and scope. The controlling rule is: Clause (2) contains a specific Governor-plus-previous-presidential-consent route for High Court proceedings.
- **B:** Correct. Clause (2) contains a specific Governor-plus-previous-presidential-consent route for High Court proceedings.
- **C:** Incorrect. A High Court cannot alter Supreme Court language through its own resolution. The controlling rule is: Clause (2) contains a specific Governor-plus-previous-presidential-consent route for High Court proceedings.
- **D:** Incorrect. Scheduled status is neither sufficient nor necessary for the Article 348(2) route. The controlling rule is: Clause (2) contains a specific Governor-plus-previous-presidential-consent route for High Court proceedings.

Examiner trap 22: The clause excludes judgments, decrees and orders.

MCQ 23. Article 349

Article 349's special procedure applied:

A. forever to every State language Bill. B. only to Eighth-Schedule amendments. C. during the first fifteen years to Bills or amendments concerning language for Article 348(1) purposes. D. only after a referendum.

Answer: C. during the first fifteen years to Bills or amendments concerning language for Article 348(1) purposes.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect. The first-fifteen-years phrase prevents perpetual application. The controlling rule is: The express temporal and subject-matter limits define Article 349.
- **B:** Incorrect. Schedule amendments follow Article 368, not Article 349 alone. The controlling rule is: The express temporal and subject-matter limits define Article 349.
- **C:** Correct. The express temporal and subject-matter limits define Article 349.
- **D:** Incorrect. No referendum appears in the provision. The controlling rule is: The express temporal and subject-matter limits define Article 349.

Examiner trap 23: A time-bounded provision cannot be used as a routine present-day gate.

MCQ 24. Legislative business

Which statement correctly distinguishes Articles 120 and 210?

A. Both make every floor speech the authoritative statutory text. B. Article 120 governs only State legislatures. C. Article 210 makes Hindi compulsory in every State legislature. D. Article 120 governs Parliament in Hindi or English; Article 210 includes the State official language(s), Hindi or English, each subject to Article 348 and mother-tongue permission.

Answer: D. Article 120 governs Parliament in Hindi or English; Article 210 includes the State official language(s), Hindi or English, each subject to Article 348 and mother-tongue permission.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect. Article 348 separately controls authoritative legislative texts. The controlling rule is: The provisions regulate business in different legislatures and retain presiding-officer permission for a member's mother tongue.
- **B:** Incorrect. Article 120 concerns Parliament, not State legislatures. The controlling rule is: The provisions regulate business in different legislatures and retain presiding-officer permission for a member's mother tongue.
- **C:** Incorrect. Article 210 preserves State official-language plurality. The controlling rule is: The provisions regulate business in different legislatures and retain presiding-officer permission for a member's mother tongue.
- **D:** Correct. The provisions regulate business in different legislatures and retain presiding-officer permission for a member's mother tongue.

Examiner trap 24: Floor language and authoritative text are different legal questions.

MCQ 25. Article 350

Who benefits from Article 350's grievance-representation safeguard?

A. Every person submitting to a Union or State officer or authority in a language used in the relevant Union or State context. B. Only citizens speaking a scheduled language. C. Only government employees. D. Only members of a linguistic minority certified by the President.

Answer: A. Every person submitting to a Union or State officer or authority in a language used in the relevant Union or State context.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Correct. The text uses "every person" and protects submission to any Union or State officer or authority.
- **B:** Incorrect. Neither citizenship nor scheduled status is a textual condition. The controlling rule is: The text uses "every person" and protects submission to any Union or State officer or authority.

- **C:** Incorrect. The protection is not confined to service representations. The controlling rule is: The text uses "every person" and protects submission to any Union or State officer or authority.
- **D:** Incorrect. No presidential certification is required for Article 350. The controlling rule is: The text uses "every person" and protects submission to any Union or State officer or authority.

Examiner trap 25: The right covers the representation, not automatically every later proceeding.

MCQ 26. Article 350A

Which formulation is closest to Article 350A?

- A. Parliament must create one national medium for primary schools. B. Every State and local authority shall endeavour to provide adequate mother-tongue instruction facilities at the primary stage for linguistic-minority children. C. Every child has an absolute right to a named school in any language. D. Only the Union Government bears responsibility.

Answer: B. Every State and local authority shall endeavour to provide adequate mother-tongue instruction facilities at the primary stage for linguistic-minority children.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect. The Constitution does not prescribe one national school medium. The controlling rule is: The provision combines State/local responsibility, an endeavour standard, adequacy, primary stage and linguistic-minority children.
- **B:** Correct. The provision combines State/local responsibility, an endeavour standard, adequacy, primary stage and linguistic-minority children.
- **C:** Incorrect. The text does not guarantee admission to a particular institution. The controlling rule is: The provision combines State/local responsibility, an endeavour standard, adequacy, primary stage and linguistic-minority children.
- **D:** Incorrect. Both State and local authority, not only Union, are named. The controlling rule is: The provision combines State/local responsibility, an endeavour standard, adequacy, primary stage and linguistic-minority children.

Examiner trap 26: Preserve the protective purpose and the qualified word "endeavour".

MCQ 27. Article 350B

What is the Special Officer's constitutional function?

- A. To adjudicate binding language disputes. B. To amend State official-language Acts. C. To investigate constitutional safeguards for linguistic minorities and report to the President at directed intervals. D. To grant classical-language status.

Answer: C. To investigate constitutional safeguards for linguistic minorities and report to the President at directed intervals.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect. The Officer is not a court. The controlling rule is: Article 350B creates an investigative reporting office whose reports are laid before Parliament and sent to concerned States.
- **B:** Incorrect. Legislative amendment remains with the competent legislature. The controlling rule is: Article 350B creates an investigative reporting office whose reports are laid before Parliament and sent to concerned States.
- **C:** Correct. Article 350B creates an investigative reporting office whose reports are laid before Parliament and sent to concerned States.
- **D:** Incorrect. Classical recognition is an executive policy process outside Article 350B. The controlling rule is: Article 350B creates an investigative reporting office whose reports are laid before Parliament and sent to concerned States.

Examiner trap 27: Investigation and reporting are not the same as binding enforcement.

MCQ 28. Article 351

Which statement best reflects Article 351?

A. It abolishes English and State languages. B. It creates an individually enforceable Fundamental Right to Hindi. C. It requires vocabulary to be drawn only from Sanskrit. D. It directs the Union to promote and develop Hindi for composite culture through assimilation, with vocabulary primarily from Sanskrit and secondarily from other languages.

Answer: D. It directs the Union to promote and develop Hindi for composite culture through assimilation, with vocabulary primarily from Sanskrit and secondarily from other languages.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect. No abolition power appears in Article 351. The controlling rule is: The provision combines promotion, composite culture, assimilation and a qualified vocabulary sequence.
- **B:** Incorrect. It is a Part XVII directive, not an individual Fundamental Right. The controlling rule is: The provision combines promotion, composite culture, assimilation and a qualified vocabulary sequence.
- **C:** Incorrect. The text expressly permits secondary drawing from other languages. The controlling rule is: The provision combines promotion, composite culture, assimilation and a qualified vocabulary sequence.
- **D:** Correct. The provision combines promotion, composite culture, assimilation and a qualified vocabulary sequence.

Examiner trap 28: Promotion must be harmonised with plural safeguards and statutory English use.

MCQ 29. Eighth Schedule purpose

Which pair is expressly connected to the Eighth Schedule in Part XVII?

A. Representation in the Article 344 Commission and enrichment of Hindi under Article 351. B. Automatic State official-language adoption and Supreme Court language. C. Classical-language recognition and a right to government employment. D. The three-language formula and citizenship.

Answer: A. Representation in the Article 344 Commission and enrichment of Hindi under Article 351.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Correct. Articles 344(1) and 351 contain the Schedule's direct Part XVII links.
- **B:** Incorrect. State adoption and Supreme Court language depend on Articles 345 and 348. The controlling rule is: Articles 344(1) and 351 contain the Schedule's direct Part XVII links.
- **C:** Incorrect. Classical status is separate and scheduled status creates no employment entitlement. The controlling rule is: Articles 344(1) and 351 contain the Schedule's direct Part XVII links.
- **D:** Incorrect. Education policy and citizenship are not Schedule effects. The controlling rule is: Articles 344(1) and 351 contain the Schedule's direct Part XVII links.

Examiner trap 29: Scheduled recognition has defined constitutional links, not unlimited consequences.

MCQ 30. Seventy-first Amendment

The Constitution (Seventy-first Amendment) Act, 1992 added which set to the Eighth Schedule?

A. Sindhi, Konkani and Nepali. B. Konkani, Manipuri and Nepali. C. Bodo, Dogri and Maithili. D. Maithili, Santhali and Odia.

Answer: B. Konkani, Manipuri and Nepali.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect. Sindhi was added by the 21st Amendment. The controlling rule is: The 71st Amendment added Konkani, Manipuri and Nepali.
- **B:** Correct. The 71st Amendment added Konkani, Manipuri and Nepali.
- **C:** Incorrect. Bodo, Dogri and Maithili were among the 92nd Amendment additions. The controlling rule is: The 71st Amendment added Konkani, Manipuri and Nepali.

- **D:** Incorrect. Maithili and Santhali were 92nd additions; the 96th renamed Oriya as Odia. The controlling rule is: The 71st Amendment added Konkani, Manipuri and Nepali.

Examiner trap 30: Maithili belongs to the 92nd Amendment, not the 71st.

MCQ 31. Scheduled and official

Which legal conclusion about an Eighth-Schedule language is sound?

A. It automatically becomes an official language of every State. B. It must be used in every High Court judgment. C. Its scheduled status alone does not make it an official language of the Union or every State. D. It automatically becomes a classical language.

Answer: C. Its scheduled status alone does not make it an official language of the Union or every State.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect. States choose official languages under Article 345. The controlling rule is: Official use is determined by Articles 343-348 and legislation, not by scheduled status alone.
- **B:** Incorrect. High Court judgments follow Article 348 and section 7. The controlling rule is: Official use is determined by Articles 343-348 and legislation, not by scheduled status alone.
- **C:** Correct. Official use is determined by Articles 343-348 and legislation, not by scheduled status alone.
- **D:** Incorrect. Classical recognition is a separate executive category. The controlling rule is: Official use is determined by Articles 343-348 and legislation, not by scheduled status alone.

Examiner trap 31: Scheduled, official, court and classical status must remain separate.

MCQ 32. Policy and rights

Which integrated statement is constitutionally safest?

A. The three-language formula is a Part XVII command. B. Article 350A allows compulsory mother-tongue-only schooling in all institutions. C. Article 351 overrides Article 30 minority autonomy. D. The three-language formula is policy; Article 350A supports facilities, while protected choice and minority rights limit coercive medium rules.

Answer: D. The three-language formula is policy; Article 350A supports facilities, while protected choice and minority rights limit coercive medium rules.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect. No Part XVII clause enacts the three-language formula. The controlling rule is: This answer preserves the policy-law boundary and the Supreme Court's protection of educational choice.
- **B:** Incorrect. Associated Management rejected use of Article 350A as a compulsion power against protected choice. The controlling rule is: This answer preserves the policy-law boundary and the Supreme Court's protection of educational choice.
- **C:** Incorrect. Constitutional provisions must be harmonised; Article 351 is not a supremacy clause. The controlling rule is: This answer preserves the policy-law boundary and the Supreme Court's protection of educational choice.
- **D:** Correct. This answer preserves the policy-law boundary and the Supreme Court's protection of educational choice.

Examiner trap 32: Facilities for a language and compulsion to use that language are legally different.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Verified relevant UPSC PYQ

UPSC Civil Services Preliminary Examination 2024, General Studies Paper I, Set A, Question 72

The Constitution (71st Amendment) Act, 1992 amends the Eighth Schedule to the Constitution to include which of the following languages? 1. Konkani 2. Manipuri 3. Nepali 4. Maithili Select the correct answer using the code given below: A. 1, 2 and 3 B. 1, 2 and 4 C. 1, 3 and 4 D. 2, 3 and 4

Answer: A. 1, 2 and 3.

Official-key discipline: The question wording is retained from the audited official paper route. The constitutional answer is independently verified from the Seventy-first Amendment text: Konkani, Manipuri and Nepali were added; Maithili was added by the Ninety-second Amendment. No coaching key is represented as an official UPSC explanation.

Elimination route: 21st -> Sindhi | 71st -> Konkani, Manipuri, Nepali | 92nd -> Bodo, Dogri, Maithili, Santhali | 96th -> Oriya renamed Odia.

Why this earns marks: It resolves each statement through enacted amendment text and distinguishes addition from renaming.

Original Mains practice with model solutions

Mains 1 - 10 marks | 150 words

Question: "India has an official language but no constitutionally declared national language." Explain the distinction and its constitutional wisdom.

Model solution:

An official language authorises governmental work; a national language would claim constitutional primacy. Article 343(1) adopts Hindi in Devanagari as the Union's official language and specifies the international form of Indian numerals, but declares no national language.

This wording is deliberate. The Munshi-Ayyangar compromise combined linguistic decolonisation with administrative continuity and non-Hindi reassurance. Article 343(3) allowed Parliament to continue English; section 3 of the Official Languages Act, 1963 does so in addition to Hindi. Article 345 preserves State choice, while Articles 347 and 350-350B protect linguistic access and minorities.

Therefore, Hindi has a defined Union function without becoming a hierarchy of citizenship. The arrangement supports common administration while recognising India's plural language communities. Its limitation is practical: formal plurality must be matched by translation, education and grievance-access capacity. Constitutional wisdom lies in unity through accommodation, not a legally invented national-language status.

Audited model-answer prose count: 150 words.

Why this earns marks: The response answers the directive, uses named constitutional, statutory or judicial evidence, explains what that evidence proves, and closes with a qualification.

Better-answer check: Preserve the legal category, identify the competent actor and avoid converting a policy preference into constitutional law.

Mains 2 - 10 marks | 150 words

Question: Differentiate the parliamentary committee under Article 344 from the Committee on Official Language under section 4 of the Official Languages Act, 1963.

Model solution:

Article 344 and section 4 create similarly composed, legally distinct committees. Under Article 344(4), a thirty-member committee—twenty Lok Sabha and ten Rajya Sabha members elected by proportional representation through the single transferable vote—examines recommendations of the time-linked Official Language Commission and reports its opinion to the President.

Section 4 of the 1963 Act creates a statutory committee after the prescribed period and parliamentary resolution. It reviews Hindi use for Union official purposes and recommends to the President. Under section 4(4), presidential

directions cannot conflict with section 3, including its English-continuation safeguards.

Thus, composition does not determine identity: source, trigger and function do. The Article 344 body belongs to the founding constitutional transition; the section 4 body is a continuing statutory review mechanism. An answer must not use a statutory report as though it amended Part XVII or displaced section 3.

Audited model-answer prose count: 147 words.

Why this earns marks: The response answers the directive, uses named constitutional, statutory or judicial evidence, explains what that evidence proves, and closes with a qualification.

Better-answer check: Preserve the legal category, identify the competent actor and avoid converting a policy preference into constitutional law.

Mains 3 - 15 marks | 250 words

Question: Examine how Articles 345-347 and the Official Languages Act structure language relations between the Union and the States.

Model solution:

The Constitution distributes language authority rather than imposing a single administrative tongue. Article 345 allows a State legislature to adopt one or more languages in use in the State, or Hindi, for all or specified official purposes; English continues until State law otherwise provides. In *U.P. Hindi Sahitya Sammelan v. State of U.P.* (2014), the Supreme Court upheld Urdu as an additional official language and held that adopting Hindi did not exhaust this power.

Article 346 supplies the default language for State-State and State-Union communication by linking it to the language authorised for Union official purposes. Its proviso permits States to agree to use Hindi between themselves. Article 347 addresses a different problem: after demand and satisfaction that a substantial proportion desires recognition, the President may direct official recognition for an area and purpose.

The Official Languages Act adds operational protection. Section 3 requires English in Union communication with a State that has not adopted Hindi as official language; Hindi communication from a Hindi State to such a State must carry an English translation, while voluntary Hindi use remains possible.

This framework combines State autonomy, interoperability and minority recognition. Yet legal flexibility needs administrative capacity: translations must be timely and accurate, and Union practice must respect statutory consent. Federal language relations succeed through reciprocity rather than unilateral replacement.

Audited model-answer prose count: 222 words.

Why this earns marks: The response answers the directive, uses named constitutional, statutory or judicial evidence, explains what that evidence proves, and closes with a qualification.

Better-answer check: Preserve the legal category, identify the competent actor and avoid converting a policy preference into constitutional law.

Mains 4 - 15 marks | 250 words

Question: Discuss the constitutional balance between uniformity and access in the language of higher courts and authoritative legal texts.

Model solution:

Article 348 begins with uniformity. Until Parliament otherwise provides, Supreme Court and High Court proceedings and authoritative texts of specified Bills, Acts, ordinances and delegated instruments are in English. A common authoritative language supports precedent circulation and reduces conflict between versions.

Access is introduced through controlled routes. Under Article 348(2), a Governor with the President's previous consent may authorise Hindi or another State official language in High Court proceedings, but the clause excludes judgments, decrees and orders. Section 7 of the Official Languages Act separately permits such High Court decisions in Hindi or the State official language, in addition to English, with a High Court-authorised English translation. Article 348(3) makes the Governor-authorised Gazette English translation of specified State texts authoritative; sections 5 and 6 create additional authoritative Hindi routes.

The design therefore distinguishes oral/procedural accessibility from authoritative legal interoperability. Its weakness is that English can remain a barrier for litigants and local lawyers. Reform should provide certified translations,

interpretation, multilingual cause information and human-reviewed digital tools while clearly labelling the controlling text.

Uniformity need not mean monolingual access, but access cannot be secured by ignoring the prescribed authorisation and translation chain.

Audited model-answer prose count: 198 words.

Why this earns marks: The response answers the directive, uses named constitutional, statutory or judicial evidence, explains what that evidence proves, and closes with a qualification.

Better-answer check: Preserve the legal category, identify the competent actor and avoid converting a policy preference into constitutional law.

Mains 5 - 20 marks | 250 words

Question: Analyse the evolution of India's official-language settlement from the Constituent Assembly compromise to the 1967 amendment.

Model solution:

The official-language settlement evolved through constitutional compromise, administrative experience and federal protest. In September 1949, the Munshi-Ayyangar formula reconciled demands for rapid replacement of English with concerns about governance, law and non-Hindi regions. Article 343 consequently made Hindi in Devanagari the Union's official language, retained English for fifteen years and empowered Parliament to legislate for later use.

Article 344 added review machinery. The 1955 B.G. Kher Commission considered progressive Hindi use, English restrictions, numerals and related matters; a parliamentary committee associated with G.B. Pant examined its recommendations. The design expressly required attention to scientific, cultural and industrial advancement and non-Hindi interests in public services.

Parliament enacted the Official Languages Act in 1963 before the transition expired. When 1965 brought strong anti-imposition mobilisation, especially in Tamil Nadu, the political weakness of a hard switch became evident. The 1967 amendment substituted section 3, effective in 1968. English could continue in addition to Hindi; communications with non-Hindi-official-language States gained express protection; specified documents remained bilingual; employees proficient in either language were protected; and section 3(5) required resolutions of all relevant States plus both Houses before specified discontinuance.

The result was durable statutory bilingualism within a Hindi-promoting Constitution. It did not create a national language or freeze policy forever. Its continuing legitimacy depends on federal consent, translation capacity and equal access rather than symbolic compulsion.

Audited model-answer prose count: 234 words.

Why this earns marks: The response answers the directive, uses named constitutional, statutory or judicial evidence, explains what that evidence proves, and closes with a qualification.

Better-answer check: Preserve the legal category, identify the competent actor and avoid converting a policy preference into constitutional law.

Mains 6 - 20 marks | 250 words

Question: "The challenge is to promote languages without converting promotion into exclusion." Evaluate this statement with reference to linguistic minorities, education and technology.

Model solution:

The Constitution supports both development and plural access. Article 351 directs the Union to promote Hindi as a medium for India's composite culture and to enrich it from Hindustani and Eighth-Schedule languages. Yet Articles 345-347 preserve State choice and recognition, Article 350 enables grievance representation, and Articles 350A-350B provide mother-tongue facilities and reporting on linguistic safeguards.

Rights impose further limits. Article 29(1) protects conservation of language, script and culture; Article 29(2) bars specified admission discrimination; Article 30 protects minority educational institutions. T.M.A. Pai Foundation supplies the State-relative minority framework. State of Karnataka v. Associated Management (2014) held that a child or parent has primary-medium choice under Article 19(1)(a) and that Article 350A cannot compel a linguistic-minority

institution to use only its mother tongue.

Policy must therefore expand capability. The three-language formula remains education policy, not constitutional command. Governments should invest in teachers, terminology, interpretation and multilingual digital services rather than measure success only by compulsory use. Machine translation can widen access, but legislation and judgments require human legal review, version control and clear identification of the authoritative text under Article 348 and the 1963 Act.

Promotion becomes exclusion when it denies services, education or opportunity through asymmetric compulsion. The constitutional answer is multilingual capacity, reasonable regulation, federal consultation and enforceable non-discrimination.

Audited model-answer prose count: 227 words.

Why this earns marks: The response answers the directive, uses named constitutional, statutory or judicial evidence, explains what that evidence proves, and closes with a qualification.

Better-answer check: Preserve the legal category, identify the competent actor and avoid converting a policy preference into constitutional law.